

text in the drawings as well. You don't need to carry notepads around to make presentations, you can do it all on Hi-Note.

Install Hi-Note in your Palm using the Palm Desktop and you are ready. Simple. Start Hi-Note by clicking on the icon. Tap on the New button to start a new note. Select the type of note—text or picture. Start entering whatever you want in the new note that comes up. It stays simple. You can draw your diagrams by choosing the Picture note option. If you want to add a diagram to a note, it's as simple as adding a sub-note to it. Just tap on the note to which you want to add a sub-note. Now tap on the New Sub-Note item from the Record menu. Enter the type of note. Tap on Done and you are through with the sub-note. From the Options menu, set Title (of the note) and Picture Size. If you want to look up telephone numbers, do that using Phone Lookup in Options.

Hi-Note's simplicity makes it a must for people who like things efficient and easy. You can drag-and-drop all the notes to structure them the way you want. If you need to import data from the Memo Pad, use the Import option in Record. Alternately, you can export data from the note you just made into Memo Pad using the Export option.

Palmy BlackForest

How do Trees, Branches and Leaves make up an outline? No, we're not joking. A hierarchical structure, which has elements called Trees, is used for Outlines in BlackForest. Branches and Leaves are the sub elements in the outline. You can have as many leaves as you want in a branch.

To create a Tree, tap on the Create button in BlackForest after installing it using the Palm Desktop.

Name the tree and tap on it to open. Go to the Tree option in menu and select the New Branch option to create new branches. New leaves for branches can be made in the same manner. Notes can be attached to the branches and leaves using the Attach Note option in the Tree menu.

You can set the priority of a branch and leaves using Details. The items which you have finished working on can be marked using the check box next to the leaf or tree. Dragging and dropping branches and leaves is a standard feature of BlackForest.

A major drawback of BlackForest is that it

doesn't provide linking to other Palm applications such as Memo Pad. This is inconvenient if you are dealing with projects that rely on data from these applications.

Arrange(r)

Arranger makes use of a tree-hierarchy for making outlines. Creating a tree structure in Arranger is



Adding new items to the Outline

child's play. First, install Arranger on your Palm using the Palm desktop. Now click on the Arranger icon to open it. Tap on the New button to start an outline. Enter the information and tap the OK button. Specify the category of the outline, if you so wish, through Details in Options.

Now that the master outline has been made, it is time to add new items to it. For adding new items tap on the Open button.

In the drop-down Edit menu, tap on New item. This brings up the new item, which will be added to the outline. Click on OK. You can also use other options such as New link to Address, Date Book, Memo, Expense, and To Do to add items to the outline from these utilities. Add all the items you want to outline using the same method. A plus sign in the box on the left side of the outline shows that items have been added to the outline. You can open the outline by tapping on the plus sign. You can also drag and drop items to act as child items of the ones in the outline.

The interface of Arranger is not as user-friendly as that of Hi-Note. It requires some time to get used to. Importing and exporting of items from and to Memo Pad can be done via Options menu.

Keep it simple

There are some things you need to keep in mind when using an outliner program. Firstly, break up the task you have in hand into simple steps. This will help you prepare a better outline. Always remember to keep the information in the outline as simple as possible. After all, it doesn't make sense to write a whole page of information for a single task, does it?

Keep these tips in mind and you can make the best use of your outliner. Your outliner is like a reliable secretary who can help you breeze through your busy day without your having to juggle between all those to-do lists, memos, project reports and others. So choose the outliner for you and put it to task right away. ■

Outliner History

A piece of information for all those of you who grew up thinking God created man, woman, and PIMs and in that order, the reality is a bit different. It's more like man, woman, and outliners. Outliners were used in personal computers for collecting pieces of information and organising them. Believe it or not, there was a time when Personal Information Managers (PIM) weren't around. But when they came along, outliners became a much lesser force to reckon with in the desktop arena.

Outliners got a new avatar with the introduction of the Palm operating system. In such systems where space is always a constraint, outliners found their own little nook. They are preferred over other kinds of organiser programs for the Palm system because organisers designed for a desktop computer can be easily ported to suit the Palm. They do not consume too many resources and offer simplicity of usage. Outliner interfaces usually take up the least display space—an important feature in portable devices. Its no-clutter nature has made it a hit in the Palm domain.

Despite their simple nature, most organisers have a lot of power under the hood. Most of them allow you to link items from the main Palm applications such as Address, Date Book, To Do, Memo Pad and others. These links can be turned into hierarchical outlines that make sense to you. You can manage To Do items, set alarms and so on, straight from the outliner. Grateful, aren't you now, for outliners?